

Moors's law now in 3D

Intel has introduced 3D transistors on its 22nm chips codename "Ivy Bridge".

Indian 3G usage: 9 million

Bharti Airtel - 3 million, Tata DoCoMo - 1.5 million, Idea Cellular, Vodafone and BSNL - 1+ million 3G customers each.

HDTV Test

Vu's LC-46V86P is a bulky LCD that is heavy, but when Vu says "Intelligent" they mean computer and this display houses a full fledged PC inside its shell. We were impressed to see a Pentium Dual Core E5800 (3.2 GHz), 2 GB of RAM and a 500 GB notebook hard drive (Western Digital WD5000BEVT). The graphics solution was an Intel G41, and this configuration runs 1080p content well, while being over-kill for surfing and such.

Sony's KDL-46EX720 is another good looking offering, second only to the Samsung UA46D6600WR. It has the best looking remote unit of all with a sliding cover housing the batteries although the menu buttons are too close to each other and this causes some ergonomics issues when using them.

Performance

Sadly, two of the biggest names here failed to impress. Both the Samsung and Sony models are based on S-PVA panels, and frankly, we found the Samsung UA46D6600WR abysmal at our 50 per cent brightness and contrast settings. Increase the backlight and the contrast to 75, and the contrast ratio rises to 185:1 from a measly 30:1, which is still on the lower side. The best figure we got was on Samsung's own "Vivid" setting - 254:1. Even at this setting, colours, while bright, appeared artificial, especially in *Avatar*.

Buying Guide		
Budget	Needs	Recommendations
Erm, I'm willing to spend, but I want the best. OK, up to ₹1,50,000	The best possible quality from a TV, price no bar, size variable between 40 and 50-inches	Sharp Aquos LE820 40" (could also check the 46" version), the colour and contrast is truly amazing
Up to ₹35,000	I'm not cheap, but I want a basic TV as am upgrading from a fat old CRT.	Onida LC032MMS, at Rs. 27,990 it's a very good buy and a good performer to boot
Up to ₹70,000	An LED TV, a cheap one that is a good performer, my wife wants something slim to match her living room	LG 42LV3730 - a nice looking, sleek TV that is also a pretty good performer and comes with a lot of features including built in Internet
Up to ₹1,50,000	The biggest display for the budget	Vu LED-55T28R - a great LED TV - good colours, decent contrast, totally cinematic. You could also check some larger plasma TVs
Up to ₹80,000	A TV and PC in one	Vu LC-46V86P - browse as you watch TV...it's a good performer too

The second disappointment although due to very contrasting reasons was the Sony. While the contrast here was better, the KDL-46EX720 suffers from a noisy output. Even with native 1080p content, the picture is noisy and this makes the forest in *Avatar* lose its verdant green and look a generic green instead with some botches in certain areas. Faces in *Ironman 2* look so noisy it appears Gwyneth Paltrow has triple the freckles. The Hitachi LE46T05A is better than its smaller sibling in every way - better colour, higher and better controlled brightness. However, the contrast in darker scenes is still poor, and the display suffers from highlight clipping.

The Vu LC-46V86P was the only LCD in this group and it gave good scores. The only aspect worthy of

complaint is a mediocre contrast ratio and the lack of a really wide colour gamut. Greens and reds have some banding, and this is worse than the blue banding we see in some displays. However, this was only visible some of the time, and the picture quality on the whole pretty nice.

55-inch: Vu LED-55T28R - bring home the action!

Vu sent us the only 55-inch TV in this comparison, so



VU LC-46V86P

Winner

For the second time in this shootout, the cheapest TV won. The Vu LC-46V86P wins our Best Buy award, not only is it a good TV, it has a built in PC too, which makes it just too good to resist.

naturally it had no competitors, although neither does it stand a chance to get awarded, for battles are hard fought and to get a trophy at Digit, you need to get into the trenches and slug it out.

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